



Agiloft RFX Writing Style Guide

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Introduction

To enhance the effectiveness of Agiloft's customer relations and communications, all documentation must be consistent with its corporate image. Corporate identity promotes cohesiveness and establishes a sense of stability and reliability, which instills confidence in existing and prospective customers.

In the way a company establishes its branding guidelines, it also must develop style and usage guidelines for business and technical content. A style guide is a reference document that contains a set of instructions defining guidelines for designing, developing, editing, and presenting the information.

The purpose of a style guide is to:

- ▶ Enable consistency within documents and allow a consistent presentation of information across a team, a project, or the company.
- ▶ Create a familiar tone for all publications so that published documents conform to the business image and policy, including legal requirements.
- ▶ Provide a common vocabulary.
- ▶ Provide an orientation or training aid for new employees or new team members.
- ▶ Define which style issues are negotiable and which are not.
- ▶ Remove the repetition of the decision-making process and the reproduction of common elements.

A Style Guide Primer

An effective way to create an appropriate style for content, and ensure all team members follow the style requirements, is to produce an in-house style guide backed by an industry-standard style guide (as the authority for settling discrepancies).

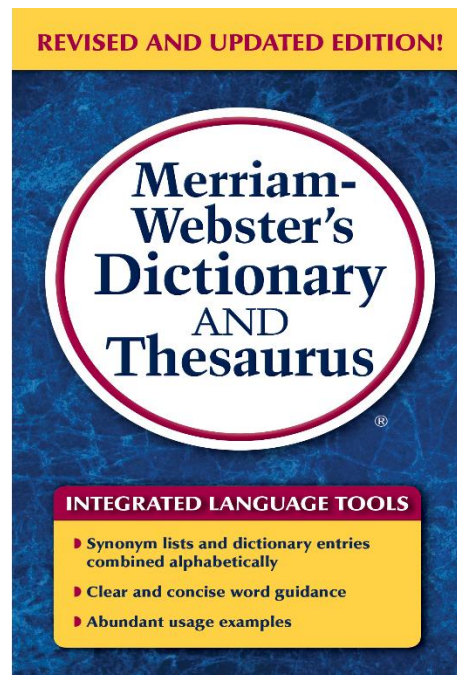
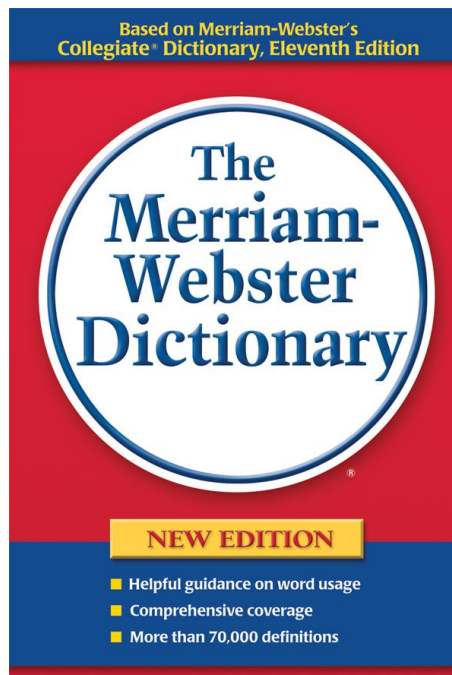
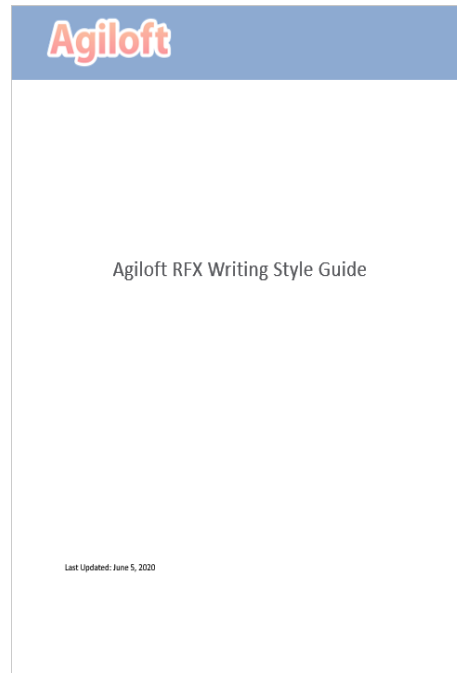
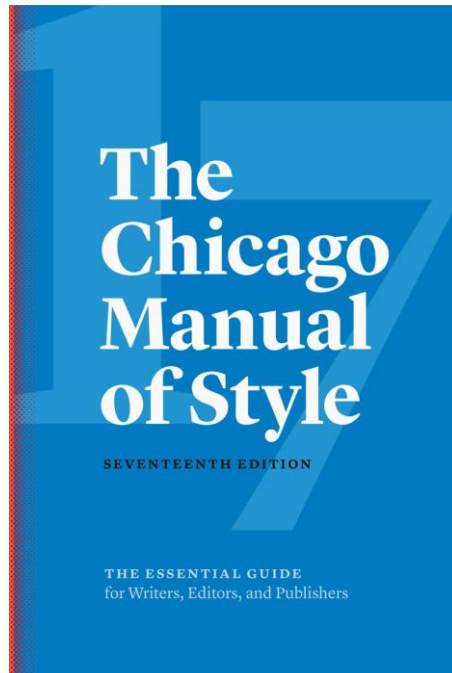
The guides listed are commonly used U.S.-based style guides for specific industries or genres.

Major Industry Style Guides	Primary Use
Associated Press	The go-to style guide for journalists and news writing
American Medical Association (AMA) Manual of Style	The go-to manual for health, medicine, and biology subjects
American Psychological Association (APA)	The standard for social sciences (i.e., psychology, sociology, education, and politics), sometimes used for engineering and business work
Chicago Manual of Style, 16th Edition	The authoritative standard for book publishing (fiction and non-fiction)
Modern Language Association (MLA)	The style used almost exclusively for academia and applied primarily to literature and humanities
Microsoft Manual of Style for Technical Publications, Fourth Edition	An essential reference for technical writers, editors, journalists, and content workers who write about computer technology

Agiloft RFX Writing Style and Usage Guide

Which Style Guide to Use

This document and “The Chicago Manual of Style” will function as Agiloft’s corporate style and usage guides for RFX development. The content is written in American English, and spelling will be confirmed using the Merriam-Webster dictionary.



Acronyms and Initialisms

The table below contains a list of acronyms used within Agiloft RFXs and supporting documentation. This resource has been compiled exclusively for the Agiloft RFX Response Writers and has not been aligned with other Agiloft teams.

Acronyms and initialisms appear in all caps. To pluralize, simply add an 's' at the end, with no apostrophe. In general, acronyms are spelled out on the first reference, followed by the acronym in parentheses. It is not necessary to spell out ubiquitous acronyms, such as HTML.

Acronym/Initial	Description
2FA	two-factor authentication
ACS	Acquisition Cyber Security
AD	Active Directory
AES-256	Advanced Encryption Standard 256
AI	artificial intelligence
API	application programming interface
AWS	Amazon Web Services
BC	business continuity
BPM	business process management
BSIMM	Building Security Maturity Model
BYOD	bring your own device
CAIQ	Consensus Assessments Initiative Questionnaire
CD	compact disc
CEO	Chief Executive Officer
CLM	contract lifecycle management
CRM	customer relationship management
CSA	Cloud Security Alliance
DoD	Department of Defense
DR	disaster recovery
DRDB	distributed replicated block device
DVD	digital versatile disc
EFS	Amazon Elastic File System
EJB	Enterprise Java Beans

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Acronym/Initial	Description
ESAPI	Enterprise Security API
EU	Eastern Union
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation
HIPAA	Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act
HTTP/HTTPS	hypertext transfer protocol/hypertext transfer protocol secure
IE	Internet Explorer
IT	information technology
ITDR	IT Disaster and Recovery
ITIL	IT Infrastructure Library
ITSM	IT Service Management
J2EE	Java 2 Platform, Enterprise Edition
KB	knowledgebase
LDAP	Lightweight Directory Access Protocol
OCR	optical character recognition
OOTB	out of the box
OS	operating system
OWASP	Open Web Application Security Project
NDA	non-disclosure agreement (Agiloft style)
PaaS	platform as a service
PCI-DSS	Payment Card Industry-Data Security Standards
PDF	portable document format
PII	personally identifiable information
RDBMS	relational database management system
REST	representational state transfer
RFI	request for information
RFP	request for proposal
SaaS	software as a service
SAML	security assertion markup language
SCCM	System Center Configuration Manager

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Acronym/Initial	Description
SFDC	Salesforce Developer Community
SFTP	SSH file transfer protocol
SHA-512	secure hashing algorithm 512
SIG	Standardized Information Gathering
SIP	Security Information Packet
SLA	service level agreement
SOAP	simple object access protocol
SOC 2	System and Organization Controls
SSAE-18	Statements on Standards for Attestation Engagements 18
SSH	secure shell
SSL	secure sockets layer
SSO	single sign-on
SVN	subversion
UPS	uninterruptable power supply
USB	universal serial bus
USGS	US Geological Survey
VP	Vice President
VPN	virtual private network

Consistency is the goal.

If you can't determine a style rule after consulting this guide or other Agiloft-approved style resources, follow your best judgment or ask the writers to select a preferred style. In every instance, the goal is consistency within the document you are creating.

Agiloft-Specific Style and Usage

Tone and Voice

The tone of Agiloft RFX content is professional but conversational; it is written in passive voice intentionally. A lot of the information Agiloft provides in its RFXs is variable and often depends on the customer and their specific requirements. It is challenging to make bold, concrete, active statements about situations for which we may not have all the details.

Boilerplate Content

The content in the [PRC Boilerplate Library](#) has been reviewed, approved, and vetted by the VP of Sales. It should be used as the initial building blocks to populate the sections within the RFXs.

Note: Please do not spend time editing the boilerplate content to make the voice more active. See the "Tone and Voice" section above for the rationale.

You can make minor tweaks to the boilerplate content, specifically in the following situations:

- ▶ Updating or adding a customer's name
- ▶ Correcting spelling and grammatical errors
- ▶ Changes recommended by the sales reps for a particular customer, requirement, feature, or functionality

Content Changes

New topics are added, and existing topics are updated in the boilerplate library regularly. At times, changes are made by sales, marketing, and corporate that may impact RFX content. The [Content Change Log](#) in the PRC is where these change requests are logged, tracked, and managed.

Style and Usage

The following style and usage items were mandated by Agiloft's CEO on March 13, 2018 and should be followed consistently. The topics marked with an asterisk (*) should already be set up in the RFX templates.

Bolding	
General	▶ Never use bold text within a paragraph. ▶ Increase the size of the font to compensate for no longer using bold. ▶ If you want a sentence to stand out, put it on a separate line.

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Capitalization	
General	▶ Do not use all caps in body copy. ▶ All caps are acceptable for initialisms and in special cases where it is required, such as a company name (e.g., IBM).
Footer	
Document Footers*	▶ Use the footer, as indicated in the “Agiloft Brand Guidelines.” ▶ Do not use a logo in the footer. ▶ The entire footer should fit on one line and be centered, as shown below in this document.
Headings	
General	▶ Do not use all-caps, instead increase the font size. ▶ Only capitalize the first letter of each word in headings, not the entire word (i.e., initial caps or camel case). ▶ Headings should only take up one line.
Heading 1*	▶ Increase the space before each Heading 1 to 18 pixels in the Heading 1 paragraph setting.
Heading 2*	▶ Increase paragraph setting of “Spacing Before” to 12. ▶ Increase paragraph setting of “Spacing Before” to 6.
Italics	
General	▶ Do not use italics.
Lists	
Bulleted or numbered	▶ Use initial cap after the bullet/number/letter. ▶ Punctuate complete sentences. ▶ Ensure list items have a parallel structure.
Margins	
Document Margins*	▶ Set top/bottom/left/right margins to 1".

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Paragraphs	
Widows/Orphans	▶ Use the “Keep with next” and “Keep lines together” in the paragraph settings to ensure that paragraph headings are on the same page as the actual paragraph text.
Parentheses	
	Minimize the use of parentheses in documentation. Instead, consider how to restructure the sentence so that the same thought is couched in another way. The em dash (—) is a useful alternative if you struggle to do this, but it is often possible to use commas to break up the thought more organically. Example: Edit the contract using Microsoft Word (changes automatically save in the Hub). Could be rephrased as: Edit the contract using Microsoft Word. Changes will automatically be saved in the Hub.
Tables	
Alignment*	▶ Left align text in tables; do not center it.
Margins*	▶ Set the left and right padding in tables to 0.06”. ▶ Set the top and bottom padding to 0.05”.

* Note: This item is preset in the RFI and RFP templates.

Conclusion

Consider these guidelines as a valuable tool for helping you with RFX responses and related work products that are consistent with Agiloft's values, professionalism, and personality.

- ▶ Company standards and style guides are part of the overall company guidelines required for producing consistent content and documentation.
- ▶ It is the responsibility of all content developers to ensure the documents they produce adhere to these guidelines.
- ▶ Team leaders must ensure adherence to these style guidelines from their respective content development teams.
- ▶ This style guide should be updated regularly and made available to the entire team in a central and easily accessible location.

Additional Resources

- ▶ [Chicago Manual of Style Online](#)
- ▶ [Merriam-Webster Online Search](#)
- ▶ [What Is](#) – The leading IT encyclopedia and learning center
- ▶ [Webster's Online Dictionary with Multilingual Thesaurus Translation](#)
- ▶ [Webopedia](#) – The Online Tech Dictionary for Students, Educators, and IT Professionals